

7-Day Charismatic Fillers Homework

Due: October 14, 2025

Purpose

This homework helps you master charismatic fillers in Business English to sound natural, confident, and engaging. Overusing fillers like “Um” or “Like” can disrupt flow, while strategic fillers enhance your charisma. Complete all tasks over 7 days (10-15 minutes daily) and submit by October 14, 2025.

Instructions

- Complete **all tasks** over 7 days, spending 10-15 minutes daily.
- Write responses (100-150 words each) in a notebook or document.
- Use **2-3 fillers** per task from the approved list below.
- **Underline** each filler in your writing.
- Count fillers and note the total for each task.
- Email all responses to your instructor by October 14, 2025.
- Optional: Record yourself reading answers aloud for extra practice.

Filler Guide

Avoid Overusing	Use These (2-3 per task)
Um, Uh, Like, Er	Well (to start/transition), So (to summarize), I mean (to explain), You see (to emphasize), Actually (to correct/add), Right? (to check agreement), You know (build rapport, use sparingly), Now (shift focus), Look (grab attention), Honestly (show sincerity), By the way (add side point), In fact (reinforce point), To be honest (show transparency), Lets say (introduce hypothetical), Frankly (express boldness), As it happens (add relevant fact), At the end of the day (summarize), Heres the thing (focus key point), To put it simply (clarify), After all (justify)

Tasks

Task 1: Filler Awareness

Write a 100-word paragraph about your typical workday. Use *Well* and *I mean* at least once. Underline all fillers. Count them (goal: ≤ 3 fillers). Example: "Well, I start my day with emails. I mean, its the best way to prioritize tasks."

Task 2: Self-Introduction

Write a 120-150 word script introducing yourself for a job interview. Include *So* and *Actually*. Underline fillers. Count them (goal: 2-3 fillers). Example: "So, Im a project manager with five years of experience. Actually, I led a team of ten last year."

Task 3: Meeting Simulation

Write a 150-word dialogue between you and a colleague discussing a new project. Use *You see* and *Right?* in your lines. Underline fillers. Count them (goal: 2 per 100 words).

Task 4: Client Explanation

Write a 120-word explanation of a project delay to a client. Use *Look* and *Honestly*. Underline fillers. Count them (goal: 2-3 fillers). Example: "Look, weve hit a small snag. Honestly, its a minor issue were fixing."

Task 5: Summarizing a Report

Write a 120-word summary of a recent work task or project. Use *In fact* and *To put it simply*. Underline fillers. Count them (goal: 2-3 fillers).

Task 6: Pitching an Idea

Write a 150-word dialogue pitching an idea to your boss. Use *Heres the thing* and *After all*. Underline fillers. Count them (goal: 2 per 100 words).

Task 7: Reflection

Write a 100-word reflection on what you learned about fillers. Use *Frankly* and *At the end of the day*. Underline them. Compare to Task 2s writing. Count fillers (goal: ≤ 3).

Submission

Email all written tasks (1-7) to your instructor by October 14, 2025. Include filler counts for each task. Optional: Attach audio recordings if you recorded yourself.

Pro Tip

Use fillers to enhance charisma, not fill silence. Pause briefly (1-2 seconds) instead of overusing fillers to sound confident and keep conversational flow.